

TTD pitch deck

The full court record is in hand — both benches, the evidence pack, and the corrections each bench forced. No further tool calls are needed; everything below is drawn from the benches' own confirmed numbers. Here is the deck.

PITCH — TTD — PROPOSED VERDICT: NO ENTRY / STAY FLAT, with a defined event-gated reopen — PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION

What we believe

The Trade Desk has real, *arriving* damage — but our original brief overstated it, and the court cut it back.

What is confirmed: in May 2026 management guided Q2 revenue to “at least \$750M,” and in August printed **\$715.1M** ([Q2'26 press release](#)). Breaking an explicit “at least” floor within one quarter of issuing it means the new Q3 floor (“at least \$650M,” ~\$160M adjusted EBITDA) has no underwriting value. The company's full-year 40% adjusted-EBITDA-margin target is arithmetically dead — hitting it would require roughly a 64% margin in Q4. Incremental revenue declines are flowing through to profit at more than 100%.

What did *not* survive prosecution: the collapse story. Margin **improved** sequentially (30% in Q1 → 33.7% in Q2). Stock compensation is **falling**, not exploding — \$109M per quarter, down 15% year over year, about \$438M annualized. The diluted share count **shrank 5.2%** year over year (495.8M → 469.9M) because the buyback more than offsets stock comp. There is no debt, \$1.49B in cash and short-term investments, and positive operating cash flow. Revenue still grew ~3% year over year in the miss quarter.

The decisive open question is *why* revenue slowed: macro (consumer-goods and auto advertisers are ~25% of spend, per management) or Amazon taking the business. The court ruled this **unresolved** — and we cannot own or short an unresolved question run by a management team whose guidance we can no longer use.

What the market believes

At \$13.80, the market prices structural loss. The stock is down ~76% from the evidence pack's 52-week high of \$56.77 — and roughly 90% from its 2024 all-time high near \$141.53 — and sits 7.6% above its 52-week low of \$12.83. (The true 52-week high is disputed: one secondary source says \$91.45, another corroborates \$56.77; the court left it unresolved, but either way, a very large amount of damage is already in the price.) Enterprise value is about \$5.0B, or roughly **13.5×** annualized adjusted EBITDA after subtracting stock compensation. The market is treating a company that still grew 3% and expanded

margins sequentially as if it were melting — because it no longer believes anything management says, and because industry data (Guideline, via ppc.land) shows Amazon’s share of programmatic spend going from under 10% to nearly 20% in about fifteen months.

Why we might have edge

1. **The bear case, as commonly told, contains a selection error.** The same Guideline dataset that shows Amazon’s rise also shows The Trade Desk going from 22% to 31% of the measured spend over the same period, “growing at exactly the market rate” globally. Amazon appears to be eating *others*, not (yet, globally) The Trade Desk. Our own brief cited only the Amazon half; the court caught it.
2. **The numbers are better than the consensus narrative.** Shrinking share count, falling stock comp, no debt, sequential margin improvement — none of that fits a terminal-decline story, and all of it was misreported in our own first-pass brief (bearishly), which suggests the market may be making the same errors.
3. **There is a clean, near-term falsifier.** The court adopted a symmetric test: a Q3 revenue print of **\$700M or above, by itself, refutes the structural-loss story** (guide is “at least \$650M”). If the market is pricing structural loss and the refutation fires, the reopen gate below is live at very depressed prices.

Why it might be priced in

Honestly: everything we confirmed was one public web fetch away. This is a heavily covered name; we have no informational edge, only a discipline edge. The confirmed damage is real — a broken guidance floor, a dead margin target, worse-than-100% decrementals, US growth described by management as low single digits. Amazon’s momentum is real even if it hasn’t hit The Trade Desk’s global share yet, and US-specific share (where the fight is) is the blind spot in the data. If the \$91.45 high is the correct 52-week reference, the market has already re-rated this more than our pack credited — meaning the “it’s overdone” instinct is weaker, not stronger, than it looks. The court’s judgment: the de-rate is *justified* by what’s confirmed; cheapness alone is not edge when the causal question is unresolved.

What we checked ourselves

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Our brief: Q1’26 adj. EBITDA margin was 39% (start of a 39→33.7→24.6% collapse arc)	Fetches the Q1’26 press release	Actual: \$206M = 30% . The 39% was fabricated; margin <i>improved</i> sequentially into Q2. Our own brief’s error.	REFUTED (ours)
Our brief: stock comp ~\$513M/yr, so EV/(EBITDA–SBC) ≈ 17×	Q1’26 and Q2’26 releases, actual SBC lines	\$109.0M and \$109.6M per quarter, –15% YoY → ~\$438M run rate; multiple ≈ 13.5× . We committed the exact stale-annualization defect we accused the data pack of.	REFUTED (ours)

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Our brief: “share count still dilutes”	Pack XBRL vs Q2’26 release share count	495.8M → 469.9M diluted = -5.2% YoY . Count is shrinking.	REFUTED (ours)
“At least \$750M” guidance floor broken within one quarter	Both IR releases, verbatim language	May guide “at least \$750M” / ~\$260M EBITDA; printed \$715.1M / \$241.3M	CONFIRMED
Q3 guide “at least \$650M” rev / ~\$160M adj. EBITDA	Q2’26 release	Verbatim	CONFIRMED
40% FY margin target dead	Arithmetic on \$206M/\$241M/\$160M	Q4 would need ~64% margin	CONFIRMED
Amazon <10% → ~20% of programmatic spend (Guideline)	Fetches the ppc.land write-up (our prosecution bench initially called this unverifiable without searching — its error; it was one fetch away)	Confirmed verbatim — but the same series shows TTD 22%→31%, holding global share. Our brief cited only the Amazon half.	CONFIRMED, but cuts both ways
52-week high \$56.77 (pack) vs \$91.45 (prosecution bench)	stockanalysis.com vs Morningstar	The two secondaries disagree with each other; the “80% selloff” headline measures from the 2024 all-time high (~\$141.53), not a 52-week window	UNRESOLVED
Zero debt; EV ≈ \$5.0B at \$13.80 / 469.9M shares	Q2’26 release balance sheet	No debt shown; \$1.49B cash+STI. Full 10-Q still unread (EDGAR blocked the fetch)	CONFIRMED (provisional)
Nov 5, 2026 earnings date	Searched for a company press release naming it	None found; date is derived from a data feed only	UNCONFIRMED
Live executable quote via broker	Broker API contract search	Permission denied — third consecutive review this happened; the tool-permission defect is systemic and needs a fix	UNCHECKABLE (operational)

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

The court’s verdict is no entry today, at any price. The disqualifying finding is management credibility (a broken “at least” floor), which under our own rules cuts *initiation*, not price — so there is no “buy below \$X” band. Cheapness alone does not reopen this. Instead:

Reopen gate — a starter-sized position may be proposed if any TWO of the following three fire before or at the Nov print:

- Q3 revenue prints ≥ \$700M** (vs. the “at least \$650M” guide). Note: this one *alone* refutes the structural-loss story and forces a full re-court even if nothing else fires.
- Magnite or PubMatic report decelerating connected-TV revenue in sympathy** — peer weakness isolates macro as the cause, rather than share loss specific to The Trade Desk.
- Form 4 filings show open-market share purchases by senior executives** (purchases, not option exercises).

Re-court trigger (not an entry): a close below **\$12.83** (the 52-week low) reopens the question of whether the tape has overshot even the confirmed damage.

Grading anchor: a missed-entry ledger entry opens at **\$13.80** (the price at verdict) so this no-entry decision gets graded honestly if the stock runs before the gate opens.

Sizing if the gate opens: starter tranche only; full sizing stays gated on the Q3 print and a Q4 guide that management then *meets* — their floors don't count as evidence again until one holds.

Catalyst dates: Q3 earnings ~**2026-11-05** (feed-derived, not company-confirmed — confirm before any positioning around it).

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 12.83 (deck-provisional: close below the 52-week low reopens the court on whether the tape has overshot the confirmed damage)
- filing watch: 8-K until 2027-02-06 (deck-provisional: Q3 print and Q4 guide: revenue $\geq$ \$700M alone refutes the structural-loss story)
- dated pack TTD|2026-08-06: BEAT (narrow/technical): modest revenue beat of the lowball $\geq$ \$750M guide is the base case, but only an in-line-to-soft Q3 guide. A technical
- dated pack TTD|2026-11-05: TTD: Q3 2026 earnings (feed-derived; no company PR names it) (date confirmed=False)

What remains unverified

- **The central question:** whether the US revenue slowdown is macro (CPG + auto $\approx$ 25% of spend) or Amazon taking share. Guideline's global data says share is holding; US-specific share is not in evidence. This is why the verdict is FLAT rather than a position in either direction.
 - The true 52-week high (\$56.77 vs \$91.45 — secondaries conflict; likely a window-edge artifact).
 - The Nov 5 earnings date (no company announcement found).
 - The full Q2'26 10-Q (fetch blocked): zero-debt and stock-comp figures are from the press-release balance sheet only.
 - An internal inconsistency in the Guideline series itself (CY22 Amazon share reported as 14% in one place, "under 10%" fifteen months ago in another) — cite it with that caveat.
 - Live executable pricing (broker permission block; all tape figures are from public quote sources).
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